

you'll find names of players who have missed significant action. Australia, for example, was without its captain Pat Cummins and Josh Hazlewood for its blockbuster home Ashes earlier this year. England, too, has been marred by injury woes to its pacers Jofra Archer and Mark Wood.

"It is unpleasant when we get injuries occurring, and they do affect the performance. That's not ideal. [But] you are looking at the definition of an injury as something that restricts a player from participating. Unfortunately, illness, fractures, those sort of things are categorised under one umbrella term of fitness. We, as medical professionals, see it as soft tissue injuries, which are perhaps more preventable through training, rehab and prehab protocols, whereas illness and the rest is just the nature of the beast."

There are indeed cases where players were forced out due to either a bone injury or an illness. Rishabh Pant fractured his right foot during the Test series in England. Then, Abhishek Sharma was ruled out for one game during the T20 World Cup due to an illness.

In late 2025, Shreyas Iyer was ruled out for a lengthy stretch due to a rib injury while fielding during the Australia tour.

However, the muscle or tissue injuries in the Indian camp are hard to ignore, especially among the pace bowlers.

The quicks are the most common visitors at the CoE, and they invariably bear the worst of this short turnaround cycle in international cricket. None presents this better than Bumrah, who has been rested for several games across formats to manage his workload, another term used frequently in Indian cricket. Even Mohammed Siraj was rested for the tours to Ireland and England to manage his workload after a strenuous two months of IPL and a Test match against Afghanistan in the sapping heat of June.

"The load on bowlers' bodies is much higher than the others. The ground reaction forces, the number

of repetitions, the asymmetrical nature of what they are doing on the load — it's a build-up of all those things. Most of the guys at the international levels are cemented into their actions; their bodies are hardened to the forces and stresses. So it is not the action as much as the workload.

"When you stress the body, there is some sort of a micro breakdown of the tissue. The body will repair itself, but that is if you give it enough time. But if you hit it again and again without proper time to recover from that load, then it is going to be a net breakdown of the tissue," Leipus says.

But what exactly is workload and how do physios decide the ideal

workload?

From a cricketing point of view, it is divided into two broad categories: chronic and acute, Leipus explains. Chronic workload is an indication of a player's fitness level, while acute workload focuses on a player's fatigue levels. To break it down further, the last four weeks of training are a player's fitness levels, while the last week of training is fatigue level.

"If their fatigue level is higher than the baseline fitness levels, then there's a high chance of injury. Suppose someone does not bowl a lot for a month and then suddenly goes to a camp and starts to bowl every day. There's a sudden jump in their acute workload, and there's a

